David Lafond

Product Designer

Montreal
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/davidlafondx

EDUCATION

Massachussets Institute of Technology (MIT)
Aug 2024 - Jan 2026
Masters of Architecture, School of Architecture & Planning
Cambridge, MA

- Certificate in Product Management, Sloan School of Management

McGill University
Aug 2020 - May 2023
Bachelor of Science in Architecture, Faculty of Engineering
Montreal, QC

- Computational Design Lab Founding Member, 8+ Scholarship Grants & Awards

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Senior Designer
Aug 2024 - Jan 2026
Tekuma Urban Innovation
Montreal / Rotterdam / Dubai

- Lead creative direction of smart-city masterplans from concept to delivery across projects in China, the Middle East, and Africa.
- Led final design delivery for Jumeirah Central, a 20B mixed-use development in Dubai, coordinating across international teams.
- Co-built ***Tekuma Intelligence,*** an internal AI-powered brand design tool for client-facing pitch presentations, cutting production time by 60%.

Lead Product Designer
Mar 2025 - Sep 2025
MIT Media Lab, Fluid Interfaces
Cambridge, MA

- Led end-to-end design of ***Momo***, a novel multimodal AI reflection app for behavioral change with engineers, researchers, and therapists.
- Facilitated weekly design sprints for a 4-person UX team, translating research and user feedback into product decisions.
- Conducted a 2-week in-the-wild study with 20 users to validate proof-of-concept, in which the structured experience improved coping flexibility, leading users to create and implement nearly 2× more weekly action plans for self-driven behavioral change.

UX Design Intern
Jan 2025 - Mar 2025
Pumba Parking
Cambridge, MA

- Led product discovery for expansion from P2P parking app into B2G market, conducting and synthesizing 12 interviews with city planners to uncover pain points, validate opportunity, and define requirements for a city-government dashboard.
- Translated customer research into product strategy and UX, defining core parking and loading-zone metrics, prioritizing dashboard features, and leading the design of an actionable data experience for municipal decision-makers

Data Visualization Specialist
Sep 2024 - Jan 2025
MIT Senseable City Lab
Cambridge, MA

- Designed and shipped Global Interiors, an interactive data experience translating computer-vision analysis of 640,000+ Airbnb images across 80 cities into accessible visual stories, iterating through rapid prototypes and design critiques with computer scientists.

PERSONAL PROJECTS

Content Creation
Mar 2025 - Present
David's Journal

- In 12 months, grew an independent design channel on YouTube from 0 to 9K+ subscribers and 35K+ monthly viewers, generating 340K+ views and 4.4M impressions from 38 videos while studying at MIT.
- Grew an online design community to 800+ members, teaching original design lessons that generated $6K+ in revenue within first 6 months.

SKILLS

Design Information Architecture, UX/UI, Motion Design, Accessiblity, Storytelling, Prototyping, Design Systems, AI Workflows
Research User Interviews, Surveys, Usability Testing, Qualitative & Quantitative Research, Conjoint Analysis, MAXQDA, Sawtooth
Collaboration Design Strategy, Adaptability & Problem-Solving, Cross-functional work, Feedback Incorporation, Service Blueprinting
Tools Codex, Claude Code, Git, React Native, React, Swift, Figma, Paper, Framer, Adobe Creative Cloud, HTML/CSS, Three.js, WebGL